

PORTFOLIO NOTES

A few thoughts on your site

For Neka Toni-Uebari From Josh August 2026 nekatoniuebari.com

First things first — you should feel good about what you've got. Five named client testimonials against real contracted work is more than most juniors have, and more than plenty of mid-level people have.

That's genuine evidence you can take a brief from a stranger, communicate through it, and deliver. It's rarer than you think, and it's your biggest asset.

What follows is the perspective of the person on the other side of the screen — someone with forty applications open who's decided how they feel about you in about ninety seconds. I've been straight with you because vague feedback is useless. None of it is about your ability. It's all about how the work is presented.

IF YOU ONLY CHANGE THREE THINGS

- 1 **Get rid of the projects carousel.** One card at a time means most people see one project, maybe two.
- 2 **Move the work above the About section.** Nobody reads a skills list and then asks to see the work. It's the other way round.
- 3 **Write up your three strongest projects properly** — challenge, approach, solution, why. Screenshots included.

01

The work is too far down the page

Right now the order is hero → about → projects → testimonials → contact. So someone

evaluating you scrolls through a full-height intro and your entire skills section before seeing a single thing you've built.

That's backwards for how hiring actually works. Nobody reads a skills list and thinks *impressive, let me see the work*. They look at the work first, and *then* — if they like it — go back up to check the skills and the stack to see whether it lines up. Your skills section is doing a job that only matters after you've already got them interested.

Flip it. Short hero, then straight into projects. Let About, skills and testimonials sit underneath as the supporting evidence they actually are.

While you're there: the hero types out "web developer" letter by letter and tells the visitor to "use scroll." That's roughly two seconds of nothing, in the two seconds where you can least afford it. That first screen should tell me who you are, what you specialise in, and that you're looking for full-time work — all readable the instant it loads.

02

Make the projects visual, and lose the carousel

Two problems here, and the second one is bigger.

The carousel

Your projects sit in a slider showing one card at a time, with nine dots underneath. Seeing all your work means clicking through nine slides one at a time — and in practice almost nobody clicks past the second. You've built nine projects and most visitors will see one. It's the highest-impact fix on the site. Make it a grid: all of it visible, scannable in a single scroll.

The visuals

Each project is currently a small logo thumbnail, a one-line description, a two-line paragraph, tech tags, and a link that takes the visitor off your site entirely. Once they've clicked out to a client's live website you've lost control of the story — they're looking at the client's brand, not your work, with no idea which parts were your decisions.

Show the work *on your site*. For each project: a couple of real screenshots (desktop and mobile side by side is an easy win), plus one or two detail shots of something you actually built — a component, a nav state, a form with its validation showing, a booking flow, a

before-and-after of a page you redesigned. Small crops of real interface. That's what makes someone slow down.

Keep the live links, absolutely. Just make them the *last* thing someone reaches, not the first.

03

Show your thinking, not just the output

This is the one I'd put the most effort into.

Right now each project tells me *what* you built. For junior roles specifically, hiring managers care less about what you built than about how you think — because they're not buying finished expertise, they're buying someone who can be handed a problem and reason their way through it. Your portfolio's job is to prove there's a decision-making process behind the work.

Use a consistent structure:

THE CHALLENGE

What was the client actually trying to solve? Not "they needed a website." What was the real problem — parents couldn't tell which nursery sessions were available? Enquiries going to a personal inbox and getting lost? Be specific.

YOUR APPROACH

How did you break it down? What did you look at first, what did you rule out, what constraints were you inside — budget, timeline, the client's ability to update it themselves?

THE SOLUTION

What you built, with the visuals sitting right next to it.

WHY THIS SOLUTION

The part almost every junior portfolio skips. Why WordPress and not Squarespace here? Why Elementor rather than a custom theme? Why that navigation structure? You don't need to have made the perfect call — you need to show there *was* a call, and that you had reasons. A defensible decision beats a perfect one.

THE OUTCOME

Nice to have, not essential. If you have Analytics access on any of those client sites: traffic, enquiries, bounce rate, load time before and after, Lighthouse scores. One real number is worth three paragraphs of adjectives. If you don't have data, pull the client's testimonial up into the case study rather than leaving it stranded at the bottom of the page.

WHAT YOU'D DO DIFFERENTLY

See below – it's worth its own point.

Don't do this for all nine. Do it properly for your three strongest, and let the rest stay as short cards.

04

Takeaways and learnings

Underrated, so it gets its own section. End each case study with a couple of honest lines on what you learned and what you'd carry into the next project. *"The client kept asking for changes I hadn't scoped, so on the next build I locked the content structure before touching any design."* *"I over-engineered the animation and it hurt mobile performance, so now I build the static version first."*

Two things happen when you do that. You show self-awareness, which is one of the main things people are screening juniors for. And you show progression – that project three is better than project one *because* of project one. That's the difference between someone with five projects and someone with five projects' worth of experience.

Also

A few other things I noticed

There's a positioning tension

Your headline says "web developer." Your About says "Junior Web Developer specialising in WordPress." But your strongest technical work – SPortal with SPFx, React, TypeScript and Jest; arithmetix with Vue, Node and PostgreSQL; ONE% with Scala.js and CI – is developer work of a completely different kind, and it's buried mid-carousel.

Those are two different job markets. "WordPress specialist" reads as a freelance web-build service, and the people hiring for that are agencies and small businesses. "Front-end developer" reads as product engineering, and those hiring managers want component architecture, TypeScript, testing, version control, CI. You have evidence for both, but the site leads with the first while you're applying for the second.

Pick the door you're knocking on. If it's front-end and product roles, lead with SPortal, arithmetix and ONE%, and reframe the client work as what it genuinely is – proof you can ship to real people with real deadlines and communicate while doing it. Most bootcamp-and-side-project juniors simply don't have that. It just shouldn't be the headline.

The accessibility claim needs backing up

You've made "WCAG AA Compliant" and "accessibility-first development" a headline differentiator. Smart angle, and genuinely uncommon at junior level – accessibility is a live legal and procurement issue and teams do hire for it. But right now it's a badge with nothing behind it, and anyone who cares enough to notice the claim will immediately test your own site.

Back it: a short paragraph in a case study on what you actually did, an axe or Lighthouse screenshot, a note on keyboard navigation or contrast ratios. And tidy the inconsistency – one place says WCAG 2.1, another says WCAG AA. Pick the precise version and be exact, because precision is the entire point of the claim.

No CV, and no experience section

There's no downloadable CV anywhere, and no work history or education. Plenty of recruiters want a document they can forward internally. A "CV" button in the nav is a ten-minute job.

No dates or context on anything

I can't tell whether a project was last month or three years ago, whether you were solo or on a team, or how long it took. Add role, timeframe and team size to each one – it's the difference between a project and a piece of experience.

No permalinks

Everything is one long page, so you can't send someone a link to a single case study. Once your top three are proper write-ups, give them their own URLs. It makes your work forwardable – and forwardable is how you get passed around internally.

Nine projects is too many

Five or six of your best, told properly, will beat nine told thinly. Volume reads as a portfolio; selection reads as judgement – and judgement is what you're being assessed on.

Small things that undercut you

These matter more on a developer's own site than they would anywhere else, because the site *is* the work sample.

The fixed nav pill sits on top of content in a couple of places – it covered text in the About section, and it's covering your own LinkedIn and GitHub icons down in Contact.

The fade-in animations are slow enough that scrolling at normal speed lands you on sections that are still blank. I hit genuinely empty screens more than once. High risk, no reward – tighten the timings and respect `prefers-reduced-motion` while you're in there, which also serves the accessibility point.

The footer says 2024. It's 2026.

The only way to reach you is the form plus a mail icon. Some people won't fill in a form, and an icon is a step of friction. Write the address out in plain text next to it.

Checklist

Quick wins

Roughly ordered by impact. Ticks save in your browser.

- 01 ☐ Replace the projects carousel with a grid so everything is visible at once
- 02 ☐ Move Projects above About; cut the hero to one screen, no typing animation
- 03 ☐ Add real screenshots – desktop, mobile, and one detail shot – inside each project
- 04 ☐ Write up your three strongest projects: challenge → approach → solution → why → outcome → takeaway
- 05 ☐ Give those three their own URLs so they can be shared individually
- 06 ☐ Decide whether you're selling "front-end developer" or "WordPress specialist" – then reorder the site around that answer
- 07 ☐ Cut from nine projects to five or six
- 08 ☐ Add date, your role, timeline and team size to every project
- 09 ☐ Add a CV download button to the nav
- 10 ☐ Write your email address out in plain text alongside the contact form
- 11 ☐ Pull each testimonial up next to the project it's about
- 12 ☐ Evidence the accessibility claim, and fix the WCAG 2.1 / AA inconsistency
- 13 ☐ Add one line stating you're looking for full-time work – nothing on the site says so
- 14 ☐ Give case studies titles that describe the outcome, not just the client's name
- 15 ☐ Speed up the scroll animations and add reduced-motion support
- 16 ☐ Fix the nav overlapping content, and update the footer year

Genuinely, the thing most likely to move the needle is getting three case studies properly written up. When someone forwards you internally, the case study is what's actually being forwarded – and it's a lot easier for anyone to put your name forward when there's a link that makes the argument for them.

Happy to look again once you've made changes. Send it over whenever.

JOSH